

ELTON'S HUGE CHORDS

How to Elton-Johnify Any Chord Progression



Introduction from Adam

This Elton John “formula” is my go-to for turning thin chords into something huge. It’s simple to apply, fun to play, and instantly gives your progressions that full, powerful Elton-style sound.

Step #1

The Chord Progression

🕒 video 9:40

This progression is **1 - b7 - 4**. Understanding the numbers is really helpful, because it means you can apply this same idea in any key — not just F.

The musical notation shows a progression of three chords in 4/4 time. The first chord is F major (F, A, C), the second is Eb major (Eb, G, Bb), and the third is Bb major (Bb, D, F). The chords are written in second inversion for the first two and root position for the third.

For this example, play the F and Eb chords in **second inversion**, then move to Bb in **root position**. This keeps the movement smooth and comfortable under your fingers.



“Don’t worry about rhythm or adding anything fancy yet — we’re just getting the progression under our fingers!”

Step #2

Movement & Octaves



video 10:23

Now add some movement. Play the chords as steady **crotchets** in your right hand, and introduce **octaves** in the left hand to thicken the sound. Keep things simple, play **loud** and confident, and stay relaxed!

Loud Octaves!

Step #3

The Elton Box



video 11:08

Take your triad in the right hand and double the top note an octave below. You're **"boxing in"** the chord — with the same note at the top and bottom, and the rest of the triad sitting in the middle.

Sus4

You can also sneak in a quick **sus4** by moving one note, adding a classic Elton-style lift before resolving!